## ENGLISH CORE
## Class-XII (2026-27)

### Section A
### Reading Skills-22 Marks

**I. Reading Comprehension through Unseen Passage** **12+10 = 22 Marks**

1. One unseen passage to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis and inference. Vocabulary assessment will also be assessed via inference. The passage may be factual, descriptive or literary.
2. One unseen **case-based factual** passage with verbal/visual inputs like statistical data, charts etc. to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, inference and evaluation.

**Note**: The combined word limit for both the passages will be 700-750 words.

Multiple Choice Questions / Objective Type Questions and Short Answer Type Questions (to be answered in 40-50 words) will be asked.

### Section B

### Creative Writing Skills-18 Marks

3. Notice, up to 50 words. One out of the two given questions to be answered. **(4 Marks**: Format :1 / Content: 2 / Accuracy of Spelling and Grammar: 1).

4. Formal/Informal Invitation and Reply, up to 50 words. One out of the two given questions to be answered. **(4 Marks**: Format: 1 / Content: 2 / Accuracy of Spelling and Grammar :1).

5. Letters based on verbal/visual input, to be answered in approximately 120-150 words. Letter types include application for a job with bio data or resume. Letters to the editor (giving suggestions or opinion on issues of public interest). One out of the two given questions to be answered. **(5 Marks**: Format: 1/Organisation of Ideas:1/Content:2/ Accuracy of Spelling and Grammar :1).

6. Article/ Report Writing, descriptive and analytical in nature, based on verbal inputs, to be answered in 120-150 words. One out of the two given questions to be answered. **(5 Marks**:Format:1/Organisation of Ideas:1/Content:2/Accuracy of Spelling and Grammar:1).

## Section C

### Literature Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text- 40 Marks

This section will have variety of assessment items including Multiple Choice Questions, Objective Type Questions, Short Answer Type Questions and Long Answer Type Questions to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, evaluation and extrapolation beyond the text.

**7.** One Poetry extract out of two, from the book **Flamingo,** to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, inference and appreciation. **(6x1=6 Marks)**

**8.** One Prose extract out of two, from the book **Vistas,** to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, evaluation and appreciation. **(4x1=4 Marks)**

**9.** One prose extract out of two from the book **Flamingo,** to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, inference and evaluation. **(6x1=6Marks)**

**10.** Short answer type questions **(from Prose and Poetry from the book Flamingo**), to be answered in 40-50 words each. Questions should elicit inferential responses through critical thinking. Five questions out of the six given, are to be answered. **(5x2=10 Marks)**

**11.** Short answer type questions, from **Prose (Vistas)**, to be answered in 40- 50 words each. Questions should elicit inferential responses through critical thinking. Any two out of three questions to be done. **(2x2=4 Marks)**

**12.** One Long answer type question, from **Prose/Poetry (Flamingo)**, to be answered in 120-150 words. Questions can be based on incident / theme / passage / extract / event as reference points to assess extrapolation beyond and across the text. The question will elicit analytical and evaluative response from the student. Any one out of two questions to be done. **(1x5=5 Marks)**

**13.** One Long answer type question, based on the chapters from the book **Vistas**, to be answered in 120-150 words, to assess global comprehension and extrapolation beyond the text. Questions to provide analytical and evaluative responses using incidents, events, themes, as reference points. Any one out of two questions to be done. **(1x5=5 Marks)**

## Prescribed Books

1. **Flamingo:** English Reader published by National Council of Education Research and Training, New Delhi

**Prose**

- The Last Lesson
- Lost Spring
- Deep Water
- The Rattrap
- Indigo
- Poets and Pancakes
- The Interview
- Going Places

**Poetry**

- My Mother at Sixty-Six
- Keeping Quiet
- A Thing of Beauty
- A Roadside Stand
- Aunt Jennifer's Tigers

2. **Vistas:** Supplementary Reader published by National Council of Education Research and Training, New Delhi
   - The Third Level
   - The Tiger King
   - Journey to the End of the Earth
   - The Enemy
   - On the Face of It
   - Memories of Childhood
     - The Cutting of My Long Hair
     - We Too are Human Beings

**INTERNAL ASSESSMENT**

| | |
|---|---|
| Assessment of Listening Skills | - 05 marks. |
| Assessment of Speaking Skills | - 05 Marks |
| Project Work | - 10 Marks |

**ENGLISH CORE**

**QUESTION PAPER DESIGN**

**Class-XII (2026-27)**

| Section | Competencies | Total marks |
|---|---|---|
| **Reading Skills** | Conceptual understanding, decoding, Analyzing, inferring, interpreting, appreciating, literary, conventions and vocabulary, summarizing and using appropriate format/s. | 22 |
| **Creative Writing Sills** | Conceptual Understanding, application of rules, Analysis, Reasoning, appropriate style and tone, using appropriate format and fluency, inference, analysis, evaluation and creativity. | 18 |
| **Literature Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text** | Recalling, reasoning, critical thinking, appreciating literary convention, inference, analysis, creativity with fluency. | 40 |
| | **TOTAL** | **80** |
| **Internal Assessment** | Assessment of Listening and Speaking Skills<br>• Listening<br>• Speaking | **10**<br>5+5 |
| | • Project Work | **10** |
| | **GRAND TOTAL** | **100** |

**Annexure I**

## GUIDELINES FOR INTERNAL ASSESSMENT

**Classes XI-XII** **Total Marks: 20**

ALS must be seen as an integrated component of all four language skills rather than a compartment of two. Suggested activities, therefore, take into consideration an integration of the four language skills but during assessment, emphasis will be given to speaking and listening, since reading and writing are already being assessed in the written exam.

### Assessment of Listening and Speaking Skills: (5+5=10 Marks)

i. **Activities:**

- Subject teachers must refer to books prescribed in the syllabus.
- In addition to the above, teachers may plan their own activities and create their own material for assessing the listening and speaking skills.

ii. **Parameters for Assessment:** The listening and speaking skills are to be assessed on the following parameters:

a. Interactive competence (Initiation & turn taking, relevance to the topic)

b. Fluency (cohesion, coherence and speed of delivery)

c. Pronunciation

d. Language (grammar and vocabulary)

### SUGGESTIVE RUBRICS

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Interaction** | • Contributions are mainly unrelated to those of other speakers<br>• Shows hardly any initiative in the development of conversation<br>• Very limited interaction | • Contributions are often unrelated to those of the other speaker<br>• Generally passive in the development of conversation | • Develops interaction adequately, makes however minimal effort to initiate conversation<br>• Needs constant prompting to take turns | • Interaction is adequately initiated and developed<br>• Takes turn but needs some prompting | • Initiates & logically develops simple conversation on familiar topics<br>• Takes turns appropriately |
| **Fluency & Coherence** | • Noticeably/ long pauses; rate of speech is slow | • Usually fluent; produces simple speech | • Is willing to speak at length, however repetition is | • Speaks without noticeable effort, with a little repetition | • Speaks fluently almost with no repetition & minimal |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | • Frequent repetition and/or self-correction this is all right in informal conversation<br>• Links only basic sentences; breakdown of coherence evident | fluently, but loses coherence in complex communication<br>• Often hesitates and/or resorts to slow speech<br>• Topics partly developed; not always concluded logically | noticeable<br>• Hesitates and/or self corrects; occasionally loses coherence<br>• Topics developed, but usually not logically concluded | • Demonstrates hesitation to find words or use correct grammatical structures and/or self-correction<br>• Topics not fully developed to merit. | hesitation Develops topic fully & coherently |
| **Pronunciation** | • Frequent inaccurate pronunciation<br>• Communication is severely affected | • Frequently unintelligible articulation<br>• Frequent phonological errors<br>• Major communication problems | • Largely correct pronunciation &clear articulation except occasional errors | • Mostly correct pronunciation & clear articulation<br>• Is clearly understood most of the time;very few phonological errors | • Pronounces correctly & articulates clearly<br>• Is always comprehensible<br>• uses appropriate intonation |
| **Vocabulary & Grammar** | • Demonstrates almost no flexibility, and mostly struggles for appropriate words<br>• Many Grammatical errors impacting communication | • Is able to communicate on some of the topics, with limited vocabulary.<br>• Frequent errors, but self- corrects | • Is able to communicate on most of the topics, with limited vocabulary. A few grammatical errors | • Is able to communicate on most of the topics with appropriate vocabulary<br>• Minor errors that do not hamper communication | • Is able to communicate on most of the topics using a wide range of appropriate vocabulary, using new words and expression<br>• No grammatical errors |

**iii. Schedule:**

- The practice of listening and speaking skills should be done throughout the academic year.
- The final assessment of the skills is to be done as per the convenience and schedule of the school.

## Project Work + Viva: 10 Marks

Out of ten marks, 5 marks will be allotted for the project report/script /essay etc. and 5 marks for the viva

### I. Schedule:

- Schools may refer to the suggestive timeline given in these guidelines for the planning, preparation and viva-voce of ALS based projects.
- The final assessment of the skills may be done on the basis of parameters suggested by the Board. Language teachers, however, have the option to adopt/ modify these parameters according to their school specific requirements.

### II. Suggestions for Project Work:

- The Project can be inter-disciplinary in theme. The ideas/issues highlighted in the chapters/ poems/ drama given the prescribed books can also be developed in the form of a project. Students can also take up any relevant and age-appropriate theme.
- Such topics may be taken up that provide students with opportunities for listening and speaking. Some suggestions are as follows:

**a) Interview-Based research:**

**Example:**

- Students can choose a topic on which to do their research/ interview, e.g. a student can choose the topic: “Evolving food tastes in my neighbourhood” or “Corona pandemic and the fallout on families.” Read the available literature.
- The student then conducts interviews with a few neighbours on the topic. For an interview, with the help of the teacher, student will frame questions based on the preliminary research/background.
- The student will then write an essay/ write up / report etc. up to 1000 words on his/her research and submit it. He/ She will then take a viva on the research project. The project can be done in individually or in pairs/ groups

**b)** Students listen to podcasts/ interviews/radio or TV documentary on a topic and prepare a report countering or agreeing with the speakers. Write an 800 - 1000 words report and submit. Take a viva on the report.

**c)** Students create their own video/ Audio, after writing a script. Before they decide a format, the following elements can be taken into consideration:

- Theme/topic of the audio / video. Would the child like to pick a current issue or something artistic like theatre?
- What are the elements that need to be part of the script?
- Will the video/audio have an interview with one or more guests?

- Would they prefer to improvise while chatting with guests, or work from a script?
- What would be the duration?
- How would they present the script/report to the teacher? Can it be in the form of a narrative?

**d) Students** write**, direct and present a theatrical production, /One act play**

This will be a project which will be done as a team. It will involve planning, preparation and presentation. In short, various language skills will be utilised. There will be researching, discussion, writing the script, auditioning and ultimately producing the play. The project will end with a presentation and subsequently a viva. Teachers will be able to assess the core language skills of the students and help them grow as 21st century critical thinkers.

## II. Instructions for the Teachers: -

1. Properly orient students about the Project work, as per the present Guidelines.
2. Facilitate the students in the selection of theme and topic.
3. Create a rubric for assessment and share with the students before they start so that they know the parameters of assessment:

- Teachers need to familiarize themselves with the method of assessing students with the rubric-- a table with different criteria and a grading scale.
- Choose the criteria on which you will grade students and list them along the left side of the page.
- Create an even number of columns along the top of the page. These columns will represent potential skill levels of the students.
- Assessing students on four/five criteria is an easy way to begin. For each criterion, define the ability that student would exhibit at each of the levels.
- The more detailed you make your criteria, the easier it will be to evaluate each student and define the level at which the student is presenting**.**
  **{Sample Rubric is attached at the end for reference}**

## III. Parameters for Overall Assessment: -

### 1. Pronunciation:

- When evaluating the pronunciation of the students, teachers must listen for clearly articulated words, pronunciation of unusual spellings and intonation.
- Assess the students for the pronunciation skills and determine at which level the student needs improvement.

### 2. Vocabulary:

After noting their pronunciation levels, evaluate the students on the use of extensive and appropriate **vocabulary** during the viva. Check if students are using vocabulary appropriate to the context about which they are speaking.

3. **Accuracy**:

   Grammar has always been an important component of language skills. As students speak/ answer the questions during the viva, listen to their **grammatical structures**. *Are they competent enough to use multiple tenses? Is their word order correct in a given sentence?* An effective speaker will automatically use the correct grammatical structures of his language.

4. **Communication**:

   Assessing the **communication skills** of the students means looking at more than language. Look at how creatively students use the language to make their points understood. Students with a low level of vocabulary and grammar may still have good communication skills if they are able to make the teacher understand their point of view.

5. **Interaction**:

   - During the viva teachers need to ask the students some questions. Questions need to be based on the projects that have been suggested or chosen by the students.
   - It is imperative for a teacher to read the essays/project reports before they can be ready to ask questions.
   - Teachers need to observe how students answer the questions that are posed to them: *Are they able to understand and answer questions independently or can they answer only when the questions are translated into simpler words or repeated? Are they able to give appropriate responses in a conversation*?
   - These elements of **interaction** are necessary for clear and effective communication. A student with effective interaction skills will be able to answer questions with relative ease and follow the flow of conversation.

6. **Fluency**:

   - Fluency may be the easiest quality to judge in the students' speech: *How comfortable are they as they speak and express themselves? How easily do the words come out? Are there inappropriate pauses and gaps in the way a student speaks?*
   - **Fluency** is a judgement of this communication and is an important criterion when evaluating speaking skills. These criteria: pronunciation, vocabulary, accuracy, interaction and fluency are all the hallmarks of a student's overall speaking abilities.
   - Teachers must also remember that some **students may excel in one area and struggle in another**. Helping the students understand these issues will enable them to become effective speakers in future. Let your students know that you will be assessing them in these various areas when you evaluate their progress and encourage them to work and improve in these areas.
   - **Finally,** teachers must remember that a proper evaluation of the students will take into consideration **more than just one oral interview on the final ASL** project. Teachers must take note of a student's progress throughout the academic year.

## IV. Project-Portfolio/ Project Report

The **Project-Portfolio/Project Report** is a compilation of the work that the students produce during the process of working on their ALS Project.

**The Project-Portfolio may include the following:**

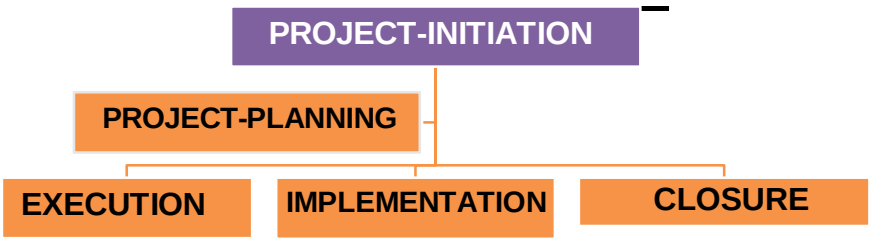
- Cover page, with title of project, school details/details of students.
- Statement of purpose/objectives/goals
- Certificate of completion under the guidance of the teacher.
- Students Action Plan for the completion of assigned tasks.
- Materials such as scripts for the theatre/role play, questionnaires for interview, written assignments, essays, survey-reports and other material evidence of learning progress and academic accomplishment.
- The 800-1000 words essay/Script/Report.
- Student/group reflections.
- If possible, Photographs that capture the positive learning experiences of the student(s).
- List of resources/bibliography

**The following points must be kept for consideration while assessing the project portfolios:**

- Quality of content of the project
- Accuracy of information
- Adherence to the specified timeline
- Content in respect of (spellings, grammar, punctuation)
- Clarity of thoughts and ideas
- Creativity
- Contributions by group members
- Knowledge and experience gained

## V. Suggestive Timeline:

**The FIVE Steps in Project Plan**



| Month | Objectives |
|---|---|
| **Planning and Research for the Project Work**<br><br>**Preferably till November-December** | • Teachers plan a day to orient students about the ALS projects, details are shared with all stakeholders.<br>• Students choose a project, select team members and develop project- plan.<br>• Group meets (preferably online) and reports to the team leader about the progress: shortfalls and successes are detailed.<br>• Team leader apprises teacher-mentor.<br>• Students working individually or in pairs also update the teachers.<br>• A logical, deliverable and practical plan is drafted by the team/ pair/individual. Goals/objectives are clearly defined for all.<br>• Work is delegated to team members by the team leader. Students wishing to work alone develop their own plan of Action.<br>• Detailed project schedules are shared with the teacher. |
| **December- January** | • Suggestions and improvements are shared by the teacher, wherever necessary.<br>• Group members coordinate and keep communication channels<br>open for interaction.<br>• Gaps (if any) are filled with the right skill sets by the Team Leader/ individual student.<br>• The final draft of the project portfolio/ report is prepared and submitted for evaluation. |
| **January-February** | • Students are assessed on their group/pair/individual presentations on allotted days. Final Viva is conducted by the External/Internal examiner. |
| **February-March or as per the timelines given by the Board** | • Marks are uploaded on the CBSE website. |

**SAMPLE RUBRIC FOR ALS Project Work (For Theatre/Role Play/Oral presentation/ Interview/ Podcast)**

| CATEGORY | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **TIME LIMIT** | Presentation is less than or more than 5 minutes long | Presentation exceeded or less than specified time limit by 4 to 5 minutes | Presentation exceeded or less than specified time limit by 3 to 4 minutes | Presentation exceeded or less than specified time limit by 2 to 3 mins | Student/ group adhered to the given time limit |
| **CONTENT/ SCRIPT/ QUESTIONNAIRE** | Script is not related to topic or issue | Well written script/content shows little understanding of parts of topic | Well written script/content shows good understanding of parts of topic | Well written script/content shows a good understanding of subject topic | Well written script/content shows full understanding of subject topic |
| **CREATIVITY** | No props/ costumes/ stage presentation lack-lustre | Some work done, average stage set-up and costumes | Well organized presentation, could have improved | Logical use of props, reasonable work done, creative | Suitable props /effort seen/ considerable work done/ Creative and relevant costumes |
| **PREPAREDNESS** | Student/ group seems to be unprepared | Some visible preparedness but Rehearsal is lacking | Somewhat prepared, rehearsal is lacking | Good preparedness but need better rehearsal | Complete Preparedness /rehearsed presentation |
| **CLARITY OF SPEECH** | Lack of clarity in presentation many words mis-pronounced | Speaks clearly some words are mis-pronounced | Speaks clearly 90% of the time/ a few mis-pronounced words | Speaks clearly and distinctly 95% of time/ Few mis-pronounced words | Speaks clearly distinctly 95% of time/ fluency in pronunciation |
| **USE OF PROPS (Theatre/Role Play)** | Only 1/no relevant props used Very little use of facial expressions /body language, Does not generate much interest | 1 to 2 relevant props used Little Use of facial expressions and body language | 2 to 3 relevant props used Facial expressions and body language is used to try to generate some enthusiasm | 3 to 4 relevant props used Facial expression and body language sometimes generate enthusiasm with the topic | 4 to 5 relevant props used Facial expression and body language generate enthusiasm with the topic |
| **PORTFOLIO-PRESENTATION** | Inadequate & unimpressive | Somewhat suitable & convincing | Adequate & relevant | Interesting, enjoyable & relevant | Brilliant, creative& exceptional |